

VERA ADIZATU UMARO

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Personal Profile

Actuarial science graduate and finance professional based in Ghana, with hands-on experience across financial administration, risk and fraud analytics, credit control and post-merger data integrity across the insurance, telecoms, microfinance and consulting sectors. Skilled in Power BI, SQL, and R, with a research focus on building an empirical early-warning climate risk index for state-guaranteed lenders especially agricultural and infrastructure state-owned enterprises in South Africa and Ghana. Seeking to build on this foundation through the graduate degree in Actuarial Science, combining advanced quantitative training with a continued commitment to community-based STEM outreach in Ghana.

Education And Training

Jan 2021 – Sep 2024: BSc (Hons) Actuarial Science (Second Class Upper Division), University of Energy and Natural Rec, Sunyani Ghana

- Coursework: Principles of Accounting, Financial Mathematics, Risk Theory, Data Analysis, Stochastic Processes, Time Series Analysis Life Contingencies
- Undergraduate research project: "Mathematical Optimization for Financial Efficiency in Economic Planning", built a constrained nonlinear programming model using Ghana Ministry of Finance budget data (2021–2024) across ten economic sectors to test how reallocating public spending could reduce fiscal inefficiency

Certifications & Professional Development

- Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate
- Telecel -Google AI Workshop
- Aspire Leaders Program 2025, Harvard Business School
- McKinsey Forward Program – in progress

Research Interest

- My research focuses on creating an early-warning climate risk index to help protect farmers and public institutions in South Africa and Ghana. By applying actuarial modeling, I aim to turn complex climate data into clear signals that state-guaranteed agricultural lenders and infrastructure SOEs can use to anticipate financial risks before they destabilize budgets. This work is about more than numbers; it is about ensuring farmers can access loans without fear of climate-driven defaults and that essential services like electricity and transport remain stable. Ultimately, the goal is to strengthen sovereign and fiscal risk management across Sub-Saharan Africa, giving governments and communities practical tools to prepare for uncertainty rather than react to disaster.

Work Experience

Aug 2026 – Present: Finance & Administration Officer — BRICS Africa Consulting Ltd, Ghana

- Manage day-to-day financial administration, budgeting, and management reporting for consulting practice
- Build management dashboards in Power BI and Excel to track KPIs and support strategy discussions
- Coordinate client onboarding and account-management processes across consulting engagements
- Conduct risk assessment, business intelligence and data analytics engagements

May 2026 – July 2026: Business Intelligence & Audit Intern (Remote), Amali Tech, Accra Ghana

- Conduct data-driven risk assessments to identify fraud patterns and internal control gaps
- Build Power BI dashboards tracking micro-credit portfolio performance
- Work with data engineers on ETL pipeline design and data quality checks

Mar 2025 – July 2026: Account Officer — Bancap Micro Credit Enterprise**Mar 2025 – Present**

- Manage customer invoicing and payment follow-up to reduce overdue accounts and stabilize cash flow
- Reconcile vendor invoices and audit corporate travel and operating expenses
- Investigate and resolve billing discrepancies with Operations and Business Development teams

Nov 2024 – Oct 2025: Commercial Performance Analyst (National Service Personnel) — Telecel Ghana, Enterprise Business Unit, Ghana

- Prepared weekly revenue reports and dashboards used in pricing and credit decisions
- Audited corporate account billing data for accuracy and completeness
- Reviewed customer onboarding registries for compliance; reconciled bank statements against operational records

Oct 2024 – Nov 2024: Data Integrity Project Lead (Contract) — Impact Life Insurance Company Ghana

- Led a post-merger database clean-up, raising data accuracy across legacy consumer records to 85%
- Supervised validation of customer application forms and banking credentials for compliance

Oct 2023 – Dec 2023: Premium Administration Intern — Impact Life Insurance Company Limited

- Processed policyholder documentation and verified signatures authorizing fund releases
- Maintained premium payment ledgers and flagged compliance anomalies

Skills and Core Competence

- Software: Excel (VBA), Power BI, SQL (Oracle, MySQL), R, QuickBooks, Looker Studio
- Communication: teaching and stakeholder reporting across finance, operations and technical teams
- Analytical and naturally curious researcher with a strong drive for continuous learning and solving problems.

Community Engagement and Teaching

- Virtual certificate tutor, Eston wood IT College (Oct 2026 – Dec 2026) — teaches Microsoft Office, Data Entry and Introduction to AI to Senior High School leavers
- I am actively involved in tutoring Young Girls in mathematics through Dr. Angela's Female African Mathematician initiative.
- I serve as a volunteer for Prof. Bruce Bayly from Peace Corps Ghana and AIMS Ghana, leading mathematics outreach programs to enhance student proficiency in trigonometry across local schools.
- Co-developer, AI-based mental health stigma detection tool, Hackforchange 2025
- Successfully reconciled legacy insurance data into new systems, ensuring zero loss of critical financial information during the transition.
- Analyzed existing transportation data at Telecel to help business decide about increasing transportation allowance of the salespeople.
- I conducted a competitor insight analysis of various telecoms in Ghana for strategic business decisions making.

Referees

- Dr. Bernard A. Adjei(bernard.adjei@uenr.edu.gh) -Lecturer (Undergraduate Project Supervisor)
- David Tamakloe (0246034541) - Premium Administration Head at Impact life Insurance.
- Eno Acquah (Eno.Gyamfi@telecel.com.gh) – Commercial Performance Manager, Telecel-Ghana.
- Jacob Adjei Twumasi(Jacob@bricsafricaconsulting.com) -Founder and CEO of Brics Africa Consulting ltd